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handmade crochet patterns

Bobble Christmas Tree

A soft standing fir built in one piece: plain rounds, then tier after tier of popcorn bobbles that thin out toward the tip. Contrast-colour bobbles turn it into baubles-on-a-tree in a single round.

UK terms

Easy - Intermediate

2 - 3 hours



FINISHED SIZE

- About 12 cm (4.7 in) tall and 7 cm (2.8 in) wide in worsted / aran on a 4 mm hook.
- About 15-16 cm tall in chunky yarn on a 5 mm hook.
- One piece; a felt or cardboard base disc is optional.

Design Code NS X02

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

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SAFETY FIRST

No small parts unless you add decorations or beads for baubles - for young children, use only the contrast-colour bobbles (worked in) and no glued or sewn embellishments.

Not tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Stuff firmly and weave every end in at least 5 cm.

MATERIALS

- Main yarn: worsted / aran (#4) in green, 60-80 g.
- Contrast (optional): small amounts of red, gold, cream for contrast bobbles.
- Hook: 4 mm (US G-6); use 3 mm for DK mini, 5 mm for chunky.
- Stuffing: fibre fill about 25 g (a little only - the tree stands on tension).
- Optional: 1 circle (~45 mm) of cardboard or felt for a firmer base.
- Notions: stitch marker, tapestry needle, scissors.

GAUGE

Aim for a firm fabric (~10-11 dc x 11 rounds = 5 cm). Exact size is not critical; droopy bobbles mean too much stuffing - the shell should hold its cone almost on its own.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sl st slip stitch

tr double crochet

inc increase (2 tr in one st)

dc2tog double crochet 2 together (a decrease)

BLO back loop only

BO 5-dtr bobble (counts as 1 st)

FO fasten off

st(s) stitch(es)

R round

(n) stitch count at round end

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Worked in continuous rounds from the base up - no joins, no starting chains. The BLO round (R9) kicks the fabric out from the flat base into the cone. Bobble rounds alternate with plain rounds; every bobble round from R12 onward hides one dc2tog per repeat, so the cone tapers evenly and the bobbles stay in straight columns.

1. The magic ring

Work 6 dc into a ring and pull the tail tight.

2. Back loop only (BLO)

Work into the far loop only. The unused front loops form a ridge that makes the base fold neatly under the tree.

3. The 5-tr bobble

Yarn over, insert hook, pull up a loop, yarn over, pull through 2 loops (incomplete tr). Repeat 4 more times in the same stitch - 6 loops on hook - then yarn over and pull through all 6. Counts as ONE stitch.

4. Contrast bobbles

Change to the contrast colour on the final yarn-over of each bobble, work the closing pull-through in contrast, then pick the green back up in the very next stitch. The green floats behind the fabric.

5. dc2tog decrease

One decrease per repeat hides inside each bobble round, always in the LAST position, so the bobble columns stay straight.

INSTRUCTIONS**1. Tree - one piece, green (contrast optional)**

The cone grows between every two bobble rows; the plain round between them keeps each tier distinct. Begin stuffing at R24 - before then the cone should stay fairly flat.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 dc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[dc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 dc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 dc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6	[4 dc, inc] x 6	(36)	-
R7	[5 dc, inc] x 6	(42)	-
R8	[6 dc, inc] x 6	(48)	base = full width
R9	BLO: dc in each st around	(48)	base fold ridge
R10	[BO, 7 dc] x 6	(48)	first bobble tier
R11	dc in each st around	(48)	-
R12	[BO, 5 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(42)	-
R13	dc in each st around	(42)	-
R14	[BO, 4 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(36)	-
R15	dc in each st around	(36)	-
R16	[BO, 3 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(30)	-
R17	dc in each st around	(30)	-
R18	[BO, 2 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(24)	-

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R19	dc in each st around	(24)	-
R20	[BO, dc, dc2tog] x 6	(18)	-
R21	dc in each st around	(18)	-
R22	[BO, dc2tog] x 6	(12)	bobble tier at tip - each repeat uses 3 sts, makes 2
R23	dc in each st around	(12)	-
R24	dc2tog x 6	(6)	stuff cone lightly now
R25	dc in each st around	(6)	-
R26	dc2tog x 3	(3)	tip

Finish: FO with a tail, thread through the last 3 stitches, pull the tip closed and weave the end down through the tree.

Stuffing: only the bottom half needs real fill - a lightly stuffed cone that flexes is nicer than a rigid one. Slip the cardboard or felt disc inside the base BEFORE the final stuffing if you add one.



On the hook - what your rounds should look like as they grow

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Contrast bobbles: change colour on the bobble's final pull-through, change back on the next stitch. One or two contrast tiers look best.
- Base: for a shelf-keeper, pinch the R9 ridge flat and hold the felt or cardboard disc to the base while you finish stuffing, then close.
- Hanging: join any colour at the tip, ch 18, sl st into the same place.
- Set of three: DK + 3 mm hook, worsted + 4 mm hook, chunky + 5 mm hook - counts are identical, sizes stair-step from about 9 cm to 16 cm.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Bobble columns wander.**

Your round start drifted with the spiral - a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round keeps the repeat anchored. A little lag looks natural: real fir boughs point downhill too.

- **Tip flops.**

Over-stuffed at the top. Take two pinches of stuffing out of the cone tip and re-cinch R26 tightly.

- **Base will not sit flat.**

You skipped the BLO ridge (R9) or worked it loosely. That ridge is the fold - re-press it with a fingernail while shaping.

COLORWAYS



Fir green



Sage velvet



Snow white



Crimson berry



Gold-tipped

HELPFUL TIPS

- Why every bobble tier shrinks by 6: each [BO, k dc, dc2tog] repeat works one hidden decrease, at the END of the repeat, so the bobbles never drift out of their columns even while the cone narrows 10 rounds in a row. R22 is the extreme case: [BO, dc2tog] uses 3 sts and makes 2 per repeat - 18 sts used, 12 left, nothing unworked.

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Safety reminder

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Avoid beads or glued decorations for items intended for young children.

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